

Chapter 177-12

Auntie Wang panicked.

Zhu Mingqi had already started counting down.

When she counted to five, Auntie Wang immediately said in a panic: "Sister Guihua took money from Miss Qiu. Her gambler husband had lost three million, and if they didn't pay up, he would be turned into a human swine¹. Third Miss was weak at the time and had contracted a strange illness. Sister Guihua contacted Miss Qiu and switched Third Miss out."

"How much money did you take?" Zhu Mingqi asked.

"A hundred thousand." Auntie Wang said. "I only carried Third Miss out. I didn't do anything else."

Zhu Mingqi now understood the whole story. She hung up the phone directly and instructed the butler to wire two hundred thousand to Auntie Wang.

As for the other person involved in this matter—Yang Gui, the Sister Guihua that Auntie Wang mentioned—she had resigned in disgrace after Third Miss "passed away." Supposedly she was later beaten to death by her husband, and it had even been featured on a legal affairs program.

When Zhu Mingqi found out at the time, she had even sent someone to her hometown to pay respects.

Thinking about it now, she wished she could go stomp on her grave.

What a piece of trash!

No one could focus on eating this breakfast.

When Zhu Mingqi came back to her senses, she first asked Shen Fenghe: "Is the situation on the trending searches serious?"

Shen Fenghe said calmly: "It's already been dealt with."

The Shen family was quite experienced in handling these things. In less than five minutes, all the related trending topics had been removed, and the search terms couldn't be found anymore.

"That's good." Zhu Mingqi sat there and let out a soft breath. Shen Yaobo poured her a glass of water and handed it over. "Don't panic. If she's our daughter, we'll acknowledge her. Don't be afraid."

"I really never expected this." Zhu Mingqi laughed coldly. "She could actually do something like this. What a beast."

Shen Yaobo paused: "It's Qiu Zimin, right?"

Zhu Mingqi: "Who else could it be?"

Shen Yaobo said through gritted teeth: "A romantic debt left behind by Shen Chi."

Zhu Mingqi: "..."

"If you had managed her properly, would she have become like this?" Zhu Mingqi glared at him.

Shen Yaobo's tone immediately turned sour: "After all these years, you're still taking her side."

Zhu Mingqi: "..."

The two bickered for a bit, but finally managed to calm down.

But the question that followed was: Why didn't Liang Shi want to acknowledge them?

Zhu Mingqi murmured quietly to Shen Yaobo: "Did I not behave well enough? Does she not like me?"

Shen Yaobo comforted her: "It's definitely not that. She probably has her own concerns."

Even the usually inarticulate Shen Fenghe joined the comforting camp: "There must be some unspeakable difficulties."

Gu Yixue added: "She's living quite well now, with a wife and children. She probably chose not to acknowledge you because she doesn't want any changes to her life."

Hearing this, Zhu Mingqi felt even worse.

She kept thinking: How much suffering did my child endure where I couldn't see?

The whole morning was thrown into chaos.

Meanwhile, Zhao Xuning sent Liang Shi a message: 【Come over.】

She sent her location directly.

Liang Shi was confused and asked her: 【Did you handle the trending searches for me?】

Zhao Xuning: 【Sort of.】

Liang Shi: 【You're really such a good person!】

Zhao Xuning: 【...】

Zhao Xuning still planned to meddle a bit more today and give Liang Shi a push.

So after hesitating, she still didn't tell her the truth.

However, she also messaged Xu Qingzhu, asking her to come over as well, so Liang Shi would have some support.

After Zhao Xuning finished messaging Liang Shi, she was still doing some self-reflection. She used to be someone who never meddled in other people's affairs. What was happening to her now? She was even meddling in something like this?

Spending too much time with Liang Shi really did make the habit of meddling contagious.

Liang Shi was also surprised that the trending searches related to her had vanished in an instant.

Even her agent felt like she was dreaming and finally asked if President Xu had stepped in.

This kind of operation clearly looked like capital intervening.

But Liang Shi shook her head: "It's probably not her."

This style looked more like Liang Xinzhou.

But when she called Liang Xinzhou, his line showed as busy. She then called Yu Wan, who said Liang Xinzhou hadn't been home for two days and had been running back and forth between the hospital and the company, so busy he was dizzy.

Liang Shi knew then that it probably wasn't Liang Xinzhou—he couldn't spare the attention.

Afterward, she also called Liang Xinhe. Liang Xinhe was also confused and asked her how all that negative material had gotten exposed.

Liang Shi was angry and snapped at him in the process: "Isn't it because of your dear sister!"

Liang Xinhe: "?"

Liang Shi had already hung up.

Afterward, Liang Xinhe messaged her: 【Was it really Guo Xinran who did this?】

Liang Shi: 【Once I find the evidence, I'll definitely throw it in your face!】

Liang Xinhe: 【...I'll go investigate for you.】

Liang Shi didn't reply to him again, then received Zhao Xuning's message.

Following her location, she drove over. It was a very luxurious villa district. Liang Shi thought it was a new property Zhao Xuning had acquired and didn't think much of it.

Just as she was pressing the doorbell, she heard Xu Qingzhu calling her. She turned around and found Xu Qingzhu behind her.

Liang Shi asked her: "Why are you here?"

"Dr. Zhao asked me to come." Xu Qingzhu said.

Actually, Zhao Xuning had told Xu Qingzhu everything, but asked her to keep it from Liang Shi for now.

But they had already arrived at the door, the doorbell had been pressed, and the servant had opened the door.

So Xu Qingzhu didn't hide it anymore. She told Liang Shi in a low voice: "They already know everything."

Liang Shi hadn't processed it yet, but the moment she walked in and saw a roomful of people standing in a row, she suddenly understood.

It was just... very surreal.

Shen Yaobo, Zhu Mingqi, Shen Fenghe, Shen Hui, and Shen Siyan were standing in a row looking at her. Gu Yixue and Zhao Xuning stood off to the side, looking somewhat awkward.

Footnotes:

¹ Human swine (人彘, rén zhì) - An extremely cruel form of punishment from ancient China where a person's limbs are cut off, eyes gouged out, ears burned, and other mutilations performed, leaving them as a "human pig." Here it's used as a threat for what loan sharks would do if the gambling debt wasn't paid.